I know she's been accused of being a kind of "shadow governor" or "shadow president" with some sort of undue influence over me. Well, that's another myth that has no foundation in reality. It's true that I'll sometimes use her as a sounding board, but Nancy has never tried to intervene on matters of policy or affect the important decisions I've had to make. As in any good marriage, I value her opinion and we talk over everything, but she'd be the first to tell you I can be a stubborn fellow when I don't agree with her.

One of the things that has been most helpful to me is Nancy's instinct about people. As I've mentioned, I tend to trust people until they give me reason not to, while she usually focuses a more skeptical eye on people, especially those in a position to harm me. She's a very good judge of people and it's helped me a lot over the years.

In any top position, you risk becoming isolated: People tell you what you want to hear and are reluctant to tell you about somebody who might not be pulling his weight or doing something hurtful to your administration. Not many people close to you are willing to say: *You're wrong*. Nancy has always been there to point out when the emperor—including me—wasn't wearing any clothes. Sometimes people who've been reluctant to tell me about a problem have felt they could go to her and she might pass it on to me; then, alerted, I'd do some digging on my own.

By the end of 1969, I realized I was going to need more time than I had left in my first term to accomplish my goals as governor, and I'd had enough experience—and enjoyment—at it to know I didn't want to stop. I'd tasted briefly what it was like to be governor with a Republican legislature: As a result of some special elections, we had a bare majority in the legislature for one year and passed some forty anticrime measures that until then had been buried in committee. I knew that if I could win a second term, the odds were high I'd be stuck again with a Democratic legislature, but I didn't